

Sony Ericsson P800

Price: Rs 39,995 A-

The introduction of the P800 is the first attempt by Sony Ericsson to break into the phone and a PDA combination market. Moreover it is the first Symbian OS v7.0 tri-band handset available. It can display 4,096 colours, and has a small keypad that contributes towards conserving space.



Since the phone has a touch screen, you can flip open and make use of the stylus, placed at the side, to operate the various functions of the phone. You can also detach the dial-pad and dial with the help of the stylus. The stylus provided is quite accurate, however its build-quality is no great shakes and you tend to loose it, as the grip is not good. To make navigation simpler you also have a five-way jog dial.

It comes with an ARM 9 processor, that loads applications swiftly. It has an audio and video player that lets you watch MP4 videos and play MP3s.

However, the video playback is a tad sluggish.

You can add a variety of parameters for your contacts including images. The calendar provided is quite functional showing you with a daily, weekly or a monthly view. However, there are only three types of events, appointments, reminders, or all-day events. Similarly you also have a Jotter application that lets you take notes down. An office application viewer is also included, which allows you to view Word and Excel files. It has SMS, e-mail and MMS functionality to let you communicate using both text and images.

The P800 comes with 12 MB of internal memory and a 16 MB memory stick duo card for storing pictures, ring tones, screen savers, themes, text messages, songs and third party applications. The point to be noted here is that the memory stick is proprietary, so if you plan to purchase more memory it may be more expensive than otherwise.

The P800 includes all the common connectors—infrared, Bluetooth, data cable—and ships with a USB cradle for recharging and syncing purposes. The most interesting feature is the radio-free or flight mode that ensures compatibility with sensitive devices. When you activate this mode, its phone functions will be temporarily disabled so that you can use the PDA functions of the phone while flying, or in hospitals without fear of dangerous interference.

The lithium polymer 1000 mAH battery that comes along with this phone will allow it to go without charging for around 3 to 4 days of normal usage—extensive usage will drain the battery very soon.

We recommend this only for a business phone class user, who is always on the move and will actually make use of the plethora of options offered. It would be quite a waste of resources for a casual user.

- + Symbian 7.0 operating system, expandable memory, excellent PDA functions
- Plastic stylus, small plastic buttons, proprietary memory stick

Companions for your cell phone

Cell phones are no longer just communication devices; they reflect the owner's lifestyle and attitude. This leaves a lot of scope for customisation options and peripherals such as car kits and hands-free sets. These accessories can be lifestyle defining or simply add-on kits that enhance and simplify the overall cell phone experience.

Let's first look at the various accessories that are available in the market for a cell phone. These accessories can be classified basically into functional—those that enhance the usability of the cell phone—and the non-functional—those that improve its aesthetics.



A Bluetooth car kit lets one control calls, keeping the hands free for driving

In the functional range of accessories, we have various options such as headsets, music stands, music players, external video cameras, desktop chargers and batteries.

Headsets have been around for quite a while now, and they can now let you make and receive calls without even bringing the phone to your ear—just plug in the ear piece and your hands are free to do other things while you receive the call.

For business users who are always on the move, a better battery life is always an added advantage. But having a spare one on an especially long trip can be quite a boon. Nearly all manufacturers today provide spare batteries and a desktop charger to charge them. Nokia even provides different types of chargers and the ACP 12E charger is the best of the lot, as it reduces the time taken to charge to 50 per cent.

Similarly, for entertainment purposes, you get MP3 and FM radio sets that can be plugged into your phone. Nokia has an add-on MP3 adapter for most of its phones, whereas Sony Ericsson offers a FM radio kit for some of its models. Nokia



has recently introduced a music stand that sits on your desktop and lets you play your music through its integrated speakers.

With the advent of MMS and support from the service providers, manufacturers such as Nokia, Sony Ericsson, Motorola and Panasonic have introduced external cameras for some of their models. These cameras can be plugged into the Pop-Port and photographs can be taken using the cell phone.

Apart from these functional accessories that make your life simpler and more organized, cell phone makers have added flamboyance to their models to appeal to the easily-bored youth. Nokia, as usual has lead the way—all its models come with interchangeable covers. Other manufacturers are not far behind.

Some other high-end models also come in their own leather carry case for protection from the wear and tear of regular use.